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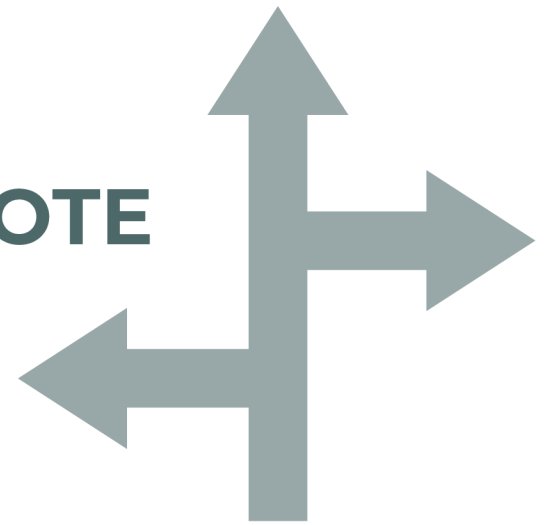
Critical Steps for Effective Change Communication



Painted Porch
Strategies

COMMUNICATING CHANGE

PREPARE & PROMOTE



Get Your Change Messaging RIGHT.

Communication is one of the fundamental drivers of change failure or success. Getting it right the first time sets your staffing firm on a path toward achieving greater change readiness, understanding, engagement, and adoption. There are 4 critical action steps you can take to provide clarity of purpose and direction, reduce confusion or conflict, and ensure the RIGHT message is being delivered to the RIGHT audience every time.



CLARIFY YOUR W.H.O. & WHY

The first step when preparing your change messaging is getting clarity on its purpose, objectives, and measures of success...along with spotting where resistance may emerge.



CHART YOUR CHANGES

Take the time to acknowledge current struggles or obstacles so that you can begin to paint a positive picture of what can be gained once the future change is realized.



MAP YOUR W.I.I.F.M.S

Identify who will be impacted by the changes being pursued so that you can speak to their concerns, as well as highlight the benefits they will experience.



PLAN & COMMUNICATE

Put this information into action. Create a plan for each communication that will be created by leaning on the information and messaging you've gathered.



CLARIFY YOUR W.H.O., WHAT & WHY

First and foremost when planning your change communications is to get crystal clear (and brutally honest) about your staffing firm's W.H.O., What, and Why. Your W.H.O = Your **W**ishes, Your Current **H**abits/Behaviors, and the **O**bstacles or challenges you may encounter. Answering these fundamental questions will help you craft clear, concise, and consistent change messaging across your organization.

1. What is changing in your organization?

2. What is the PRIMARY driver of this change? Why is this being pursued?

3. What is the outcome you desire to have realized? *Try to summarize in one sentence that could be repeated regularly, like a news headline.*

4. What are your measure(s) and milestones for change success? How will you recognize & celebrate them?



5. When will you consider this change "complete" and your desired objectives realized?

6. What are the core values of your organization?

7. What are a few examples of when these values were demonstrated well in the recent past?

8. How do your values align with and support this change initiative? How & when might you lean on them during this project?

9. In what way(s) might these values be a potential barrier to your change efforts? How/when might these values slow or impede your change?



10. What are the potential risks to achieving your desired change goals? *Think about things like mindsets, culture, perceptions, and habits but also logistical risks like technology, time of year/seasonal trends, and the like.*

11. When was the last time you attempted a change of this size or impact? How did it go on a scale of 1-10?

12. What did you learn and how will you apply it with THIS change?

13. What are the primary communication methods you will use, and who will each method come from (e.g., Town Halls led by Exec Sponsor, newsletters from Project team)? Which ones work best, based on past initiatives?



CHART YOUR CHANGES

To drive employee engagement and adoption of something "new", it's important to recognize the struggles of the present so that you can begin to paint a picture for both your internal teams and external clients of what's possible. By acknowledging "what is", it gives reassurance around what the future may provide and can help ease worries or resistance to what's coming.

Current State Problem/Obstacle	Future State Solution/Opportunity	Who Benefits?



MAP YOUR W.I.I.F.M.S

W.I.I.F.M. = What's in it for Me. Understanding WHO will be impacted by this change initiative, as well as identifying in what ways they will experience practical solutions to their current obstacles, or positive benefits and opportunities, will further provide guidance and targeted benefit statements you can use when communicating with each impacted audience.

Impact Audience #1

Top 3 Positive Impact Areas/Benefits

01

02

03

Impact Audience #2

Top 3 Positive Impact Areas/Benefits

01

02

03

Impact Audience #3

Top 3 Positive Impact Areas/Benefits

01

02

03

Impact Audience #4

Top 3 Positive Impact Areas/Benefits

01

02

03

Impact Audience #5

Top 3 Positive Impact Areas/Benefits

01

02

03



COMMUNICATE & ACT

Transparent, clear, and consistent communication is one of the most important elements that drives trust, reduces misalignment, and promotes positive change collaboration and adoption in an organization. Use this form to help prepare for each communication, and ensure maximum clarity, comprehension, and impact.

 WHAT IS THE PURPOSE OF THE COMMUNICATION?



 WHAT IS THE INTENDED GOAL? WHAT DO YOU WANT TO ENSURE IS UNDERSTOOD?



 WHO WILL YOU BE COMMUNICATING TO (WHICH IMPACT AUDIENCE?)



 WHO IS THE COMMUNICATION COMING FROM?



 WHO IS RESPONSIBLE FOR CREATING THE COMMUNICATION?



 WHEN WILL THE MESSAGE BE DELIVERED/COMMUNICATED?



 HOW WILL YOU MEASURE UNDERSTANDING AND ADDRESS QUESTIONS OR FEEDBACK?

